

CFES

CANADIAN FEDERATION OF ENGINEERING STUDENTS



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LA FÉDÉRATION CANADIENNE DES ÉTUDIANT.E.S EN GÉNIE

Canadian Federation of Engineering Students

Document of Stances

English Edition

Revision Date: 20/11/2025
Revised By: CFES Board of Directors

Online Accessibility and Academic Accommodations

Adopted:

CELC 2024 [2024-01-05]

Last Updated:

2024-01-05

The Official Stance:

The Canadian Federation of Engineering Students believes that educational resources [recordings, lecture notes etc.] should remain accessible online at the same level of quality as in-person sessions. The CFES further believes that accommodations need to be in place for assessments throughout the academic term for extenuating circumstances, illness, and other personal matters, providing catered support to all engineering students.

The Students' Position

- All engineering students should have equal opportunity to pursue and excel in their education, regardless of individual abilities and circumstances.
- COVID-19 presented the opportunity to have permanent online resources that have been favored by engineering students to improve their academic performance.
- A universal design approach for educational resources and examinations does not accommodate for diverse needs and learning challenges.
- Traditional assessments do not reflect understanding of content in all situations due to the high stress environment and necessity to perform on the spot.
- Accommodations should be provided on a need basis to cater and support engineering students in their education and to encourage their success.

Recommendations to Partners, Stakeholders, and Other Entities

- The CFES calls on the Canadian Engineering Accreditation Board (CEAB) to encourage institutions in the process of updating their institution policies and being more inclusive to hybrid education and online permanent materials.
- The CFES calls on the Canadian Engineering Accreditation Board to assess the accommodations and accessibility available in an engineering program when undergoing an accreditation visit.
- The CFES calls on the Engineering Deans Canada to encourage institutions to create a standard hybrid model for course delivery based on student feedback on the program.
- The CFES calls on the Engineering Deans Canada to ensure accommodations are granted to those with diverse circumstances or disadvantages in order to promote equity in engineering.

What the CFES is doing

- The 2023 National Survey is collecting information on academic resources and availability.
- Literature reviews on education in a post-pandemic world that found positives from online learning.
- The CFES continues to meet with stakeholders surrounding the flexibility of education and quality of education.

What the CFES plans to do

- The CFES will work with stakeholders and partners to find an even ground to begin policy work for online accommodations and academic accessibility in engineering education.
- The CFES will create resources to support the membership to advocate for online accessibility and academic accommodations through letters of support.
- The CFES will gather more information and testimonials on current student policy and experiences surrounding online accessibility and academic accommodations.